

A Letter from the Head of International Press

Dear Members of the International Press,

Welcome to the newsroom of diplomacy. You are about to assume a role that carries both creative liberty and editorial responsibility. The International Press, although not a conventional MUN committee, is indispensable to the simulation. As members of the press corps at Resolve MUN 2026, you are tasked with documenting events, interpreting developments, and presenting them to an audience that was not present in the committee rooms. This is a task that demands not only accuracy and efficiency, but also discretion, clarity, and a sound understanding of the nuances of international diplomacy.

The Press is often described as the lens through which the world interprets political events. At this conference, that lens will be yours to polish. Every delegate's argument, every amendment passed or debated, and every shift in the tone of discourse gains permanence through your words. Our newsletter is not merely a collection of articles; it is a record, a reflection, and sometimes, an interpretation of the mood and meaning of diplomatic discussions.

This style guide has been created not merely to establish uniformity in formatting or submission, but to serve as a comprehensive reference for your preparation and performance throughout the conference. It is the result of several prior experiences as a reporter, lessons from challenges faced in previous simulations, and a commitment to elevating journalistic standards within MUN platforms. You will find herein a detailed breakdown of submission types, research strategies, formatting guidelines, code of conduct, and evaluation criteria, all aimed at ensuring that our work as a press team remains coherent, credible, and consistent.

If you are new to MUN journalism, do not approach this with fear. If you are experienced, do not approach it with complacency. Everyone has a role in shaping the voice of the International Press at [Insert Conference Name Here]. Together, we will build a press room where reliability is never compromised, where style meets structure, and where reporting remains dignified even when it is critical.

Let us work with focus, punctuality, and professionalism. As Christiane Amanpour reminds us, "Be truthful, be fearless, and be fair."

Regards,

Nethi Saraschandra
Head of International Press
saraschandramun@gmail.com

Aanya Patel
Editor-in-Chief
25aanyapatel@gmail.com

A Brief History of Journalism

Journalism began in ancient times with public bulletins like Rome's *Acta Diurna*, which recorded daily events and government announcements and were publicly posted to inform citizens. The invention of Gutenberg's printing press in the 15th century revolutionized journalism by enabling mass production and wider dissemination of news. Over the centuries, journalism evolved from simply sharing information to becoming a vital tool for social critique, political accountability, and public discourse.

During the 18th and 19th centuries, independent newspapers emerged, often challenging ruling powers despite facing censorship. The 20th century saw investigative journalism reach new heights, exposing corruption and major scandals, such as war coverage and the Watergate affair. Today, digital media has transformed news delivery, but journalism's fundamental mission remains the same: to inform the public, question those in power, and document history. Within Model United Nations, the International Press carries this tradition, committed to impartial and insightful reporting. As George Orwell stated, "Journalism is printing what someone else does not want printed; everything else is public relations."

What is the International Press in MUN?

The International Press in Model United Nations is a unique simulated news agency that plays a crucial role in reflecting and analysing committee proceedings. Unlike traditional MUN committees that draft resolutions and engage in negotiations, the International Press is tasked with monitoring debates, conducting interviews, and producing various journalistic content such as news reports, editorials, opinion pieces, and interviews. This content serves to communicate key developments to the wider MUN community, providing a comprehensive and nuanced portrayal of the simulation.

Reporters in the International Press are assigned to specific committees, known as beats, to ensure consistent and thorough coverage. Their work involves careful observation, critical analysis of diplomatic strategies, and clear, factual reporting grounded in neutrality and professionalism. Freed from representing national interests, journalists maintain an objective stance, focusing on truth and transparency. Through their efforts, they enhance accountability and promote informed discourse within the conference.

The International Press also organizes press conferences and collaborates on special features, providing delegates opportunities to communicate through press releases and media engagements. This dynamic interaction helps simulate real-world international relations and media challenges.

By delivering accurate and insightful reporting, the International Press elevates the conference experience, advancing understanding and intellectual dialogue beyond routine debate.

What Makes a Good MUN Journalist?

Journalism in a Model UN environment requires a specific set of skills, separate from those required of a delegate. While a delegate constructs arguments to advocate for a position, a journalist interprets those arguments within a broader context, questions their implications, and translates committee dynamics into readable, accurate, and relevant content.

A successful MUN journalist begins with a commitment to inquiry. It is not enough to report who spoke and for how long. Instead, the journalist must probe deeper; Why did the delegate take that stance? How was it received? Was it backed by precedent or evidence? Is there an inconsistency in what was said today and what was claimed yesterday?

Secondly, effective journalism at MUN depends heavily on research and factual accuracy. While you are not expected to be an expert on every country or topic, you must be capable of understanding the broader context of the agenda. This includes historical relevance, recent developments, and international positions. Vague references or misrepresentation of facts diminish the credibility of your work.

Another essential attribute is clarity of expression. A strong article is not only factually correct but also structured in a way that is engaging and comprehensible. Avoid jargon, overly complex language, and verbose phrasing. Prioritise logical sequencing, paragraphing, and stylistic coherence. The aim is not to impress the reader with vocabulary, but to inform them with precision and style.

Professional conduct is equally important. Your articles should reflect respect for the institution being simulated, the delegates participating in it, and the ethical standards of journalism. Humour, satire, or creative liberties must never come at the cost of personal dignity or diplomatic courtesy.

Finally, remember that the International Press operates as a team. Collaboration with fellow reporters, coordination with photojournalists, and timely communication with the editorial board are all part of the journalistic process. Your ability to function cohesively in a team setting will often determine the overall quality of the press output.

The defining traits of a MUN journalist are not aggressiveness or verbosity but **clarity, neutrality, consistency, and precision**. These are the benchmarks upon which your work will be assessed and remembered.

Research Guidelines and Source Hierarchy

For any journalist, especially within a structured simulation such as a Model United Nations conference, the foundation of credible reporting lies in responsible and verifiable research. While creativity plays a role in presentation, factual accuracy is non-negotiable. As members of the International Press, all statements made in your submissions, whether factual descriptions, analytical interpretations, or editorial opinions, must be supported by data and sources that meet a clear standard of reliability.

I. Primary Sources

Primary sources are the most reliable and should be prioritised in research and referencing. These are documents or statements released by official entities and international institutions.

Examples include:

- United Nations resolutions, treaties, committee reports, and official briefings
- UN-affiliated agency publications: WHO, UNHRC, UNODC, UNEP, etc.
- Government white papers, legal statutes, constitutional texts
- Statements by heads of state or official spokespersons (attributed through formal release)
- Verdicts from international courts (ICJ, ICC, ECHR)

Use Case: To support legal claims, national positions, or official definitions during analysis or beat reporting.

II. Secondary Sources

Secondary sources offer interpretation or coverage of original events and are acceptable for substantiating opinions or framing narrative context. However, they must be cited responsibly and limited to reputed publishers.

Examples include:

- International and national media outlets: Reuters, BBC, The Hindu, Al Jazeera, The Indian Express, Deutsche Welle
- Peer-reviewed articles and scholarly publications (where applicable)
- Policy research organisations such as Carnegie India, ORF, IDSA, Brookings Institution
- Delegate statements or speeches reported by recognised outlets

These sources are appropriate for opinion pieces and background references, especially when primary material is unavailable or insufficient.

III. Tertiary and Conditional Sources

These include sources that are open-source, crowd-edited, or unverifiable in origin. While not wholly unusable, they must be handled with discretion and only used when no credible alternatives exist.

Examples:

- Wikipedia
- Social media posts (X, Instagram, etc.): Only valid if posted from verified official government or organisational handles
- Blogs and independent commentary: Permissible only if the author is credentialed or affiliated with a reputed institution

Any information from such platforms must be **cross-verified** and cited carefully to avoid misinformation.

IV. Special Provisions for Indian Committees

In the case of **Indian parliamentary or national committees** (such as Lok Sabha, Rajya Sabha, All India Political Parties Meet, etc.), reporters must apply a contextual shift in their research strategy. These simulations require greater familiarity with Indian constitutional principles, political history, and regional dynamics.

Recommended sources:

- **PRS Legislative Research** (prsindia.org) – for bill summaries, legislative procedures, and debates
- **Press Information Bureau** (pib.gov.in) – for official government releases
- **Law Commission Reports and Supreme Court judgments** – for legal clarity
- **News media (Indian):** The Hindu, The Indian Express, Business Standard, LiveLaw, Scroll.in
- **Historical sources:** Constituent Assembly Debates, writings of B.R. Ambedkar, Nehru, Tagore, etc. (when used with clear intent)

Journalists covering Indian committees must be careful when quoting party representatives or discussing controversial matters. Use formal identifiers (e.g., “the representative of the Indian National Congress” rather than “Rahul Gandhi”), and avoid editorialising political personalities.

For editorials, neutrality must be maintained even when analysing polarised topics such as reservations, communal policy, or federal disputes. Do not rely on state-linked media or social media speculation without confirmation from multiple reputable outlets.

General Notes on Research Practice

Always cite sources clearly, either as footnotes or in a reference list. When unsure, seek guidance from the editorial head. Avoid quoting unverifiable delegate claims unless confirmed by multiple sources or publicly repeated. Keep detailed notes on dates, data origins, and speaker attribution. Rigorous, transparent research is the foundation of your credibility, factual accuracy is crucial to maintain the impact of your reporting.

Types of Submissions

The International Press thrives on diversity of format and flexibility of style. As a journalist, you will be expected to engage with various formats of writing, each tailored to a specific purpose, tone, and outcome. Each article type reflects a different aspect of reporting, be it factual documentation, personal opinion, focused commentary, or creative interpretation. It is crucial to understand the distinction between these forms and the expectations attached to each.

The following are the primary categories of submissions that every reporter should be prepared to deliver during the course of the conference. The editorial board may also introduce special formats based on the committee proceedings or thematic needs.

1. Opinionated Editorial

An opinionated editorial, commonly referred to as an Op-Ed, is an article where the journalist expresses a critical perspective on a particular topic or development that occurred within the committee. The distinguishing feature of an Op-Ed is that it is subjective yet substantiated. The writer is allowed to take a position, but must support it with evidence, logical reasoning, and policy context.

This form demands a clear thesis, coherent argumentation, and depth of understanding. It should neither be a biased outburst nor a superficial commentary. Editorials should refer to specific statements, actions, or dynamics observed in committee and should place them within the broader scope of diplomacy or real-world relevance.

Word Limit: 500 – 600 words

Tone: Formal, Analytical, Balanced

2. Beat

A beat report is a focused, factual coverage of a particular issue or moment within the committee. Unlike the editorial, it does not carry the opinion of the reporter. It isolates one key development; for example, a controversial statement, a deadlock in debate, or a newly proposed resolution, and describes it in a structured, neutral manner.

Beat reports are meant to offer precision. They are often shorter, written in the third person, and restricted to one event or topic. It is important that a beat report avoids exaggeration, and instead, relies on careful note-taking and accurate reproduction of facts.

Word Limit: 300 – 400 words

Tone: Objective, Concise, Informative

3. Feature or Creative Piece

This format provides space for expressive, creative engagement with the committee's themes. A feature can take the form of a fictional narrative, a poem, a character sketch, a satirical story, or a diary entry. The only requirement is that it should be tied to the committee agenda in a meaningful way.

The creative piece is not an escape from factual reporting but a transformation of it into imaginative form. It must reflect your understanding of the committee, while adopting a narrative or literary style. Creativity should never come at the cost of thematic relevance.

Word Limit: 150 – 800 words (depending on format)

Tone: Flexible

4. Interview Transcript

This format captures the interaction between a reporter and a delegate. An interview must revolve around a coherent line of questioning, usually based on the delegate's statements or stance in committee. The transcript should be structured as a dialogue, maintaining accuracy and flow.

The purpose of an interview is not only to clarify a delegate's position but also to provide readers with insight into diplomatic intentions and committee dynamics. Interviews should avoid excessive summarisation. While minor editing for clarity is acceptable, the essence of the delegate's response must remain intact.

Word Limit: 450 – 550 words

Tone: Neutral, Conversational

5. Consolidated Report

The consolidated report provides an overall summary of committee proceedings. It is generally submitted at the end of a session or day and must encompass the key developments, debates, and outcomes in a linear, structured format. Unlike a beat report, it addresses multiple developments, usually across time.

Consolidated reports should avoid anecdotal writing or personal commentary. Their value lies in giving readers a bird's eye view of the committee without entering the domain of opinion. These reports should be chronological, well-segmented, and clearly attributed.

Word Limit: 300 – 350 words

Tone: Factual, Summative, Chronological

6. Opinion Poll

An opinion poll is an analytical article based on delegate responses to a set of pre-determined or live questions. Reporters may conduct surveys during unmoderated caucuses, breaks, or through structured forms, and present their findings using charts, graphs, or simple statistics.

The article should include the question posed, the number and range of respondents, and an objective analysis of the responses. This format allows reporters to engage with a broader group of delegates and present a reflection of the committee's internal consensus or division.

Word Limit: 250 – 350 words

Tone: Analytical, Statistical, Neutral

Press Conferences

Press conferences are formal opportunities for the International Press to question delegates regarding their statements, stances, and conduct during committee. These sessions simulate diplomatic media briefings and allow reporters to raise pertinent questions that may not surface through formal debate.

While the tone must remain professional, reporters are permitted, and even encouraged, to frame their questions with clarity, wit, and strategic depth, especially when a delegate's position invites contradiction or ambiguity. The aim is not confrontation for its own sake, but clarity that holds rhetorical weight.

Guidelines for Reporters

- **Address the Issue First:** Ensure your question is grounded in the committee context. Begin with a reference to the delegate's policy, statement, or action before introducing any interpretative layer.
- **Precision Over Provocation:** Avoid vague or rhetorical buildup. Instead, present your concern directly, allowing the phrasing or implication to carry its weight without unnecessary elaboration.
- **Wit, Where Warranted:** A well-placed phrase or cleverly worded question is permissible if it serves a journalistic function; to expose inconsistency, highlight selective memory, or clarify double standards. Tone must remain respectful.
- **Permitted Pressure:** Reporters may frame questions that challenge a delegate's previous stance, request accountability for sudden shifts, or highlight omissions in argumentation, provided the logic is sound and phrasing is professional.
- **No Personalisation:** Delegates must be referred to solely by their designation (e.g., "the delegate of France"), not by real names, institutions, or known affiliations.
- **Follow-Ups with Restraint:** If permitted by the head of International Press, a follow-up may be asked, but it must respond to the delegate's previous answer, not merely restate your position. Avoid repetition masked as insistence.

Formatting Rules and Submission Protocols

To ensure clarity, uniformity, and ease of editing, all articles submitted to the International Press must adhere to the following formatting guidelines. These standards have been established to maintain professional coherence across the press corpus, to simplify the editorial process, and to reflect the decorum expected from a formal publication at a Model United Nations conference.

All submissions that do not meet these formatting requirements may be returned for revision or marked accordingly.

I. Document Formatting Standards

- **Font:** Times New Roman
- **Font Size:**
 - Title – 14 pt, Bold, Centre-Aligned
 - Byline – 13 pt, Italics, Justified
 - Body – 12 pt, Justified

- **Paragraph Indentation:** None (use spacing between paragraphs, not tabs)
- **Language:** British English must be followed consistently.
- **Numerical Formatting:** Numbers up to one hundred must be written in words. Only numbers greater than one hundred may be expressed using numerals.
- **Chronological Consistency:** Stick to the timeline of your assigned committee. If the committee is based on a historical event, ensure that all references, tone, and framing align with that specific time period.
- **File Format: .doc or .docx (Microsoft Word) format only.** PDFs, onedrive or google drive links and handwritten formats will not be accepted.

II. Submission Labelling

Each file must be named using the following format:

YourName_SubmissionType_Committee_Day

Example: Saraschandra_OpEd_UNHRC_Day1, Saraschandra_Beat_LokSabha_Day2

This same naming convention must be used in the subject line of the email as the submissions are being sent by mail.

III. Byline Guidelines

Every article must include a byline immediately following the title. The byline should be written in one or two full sentences summarising the nature of the article.

Format:

Nethi Saraschandra, reporting from the United Nations Human Rights Council (UNHRC), analyses the diverging opinions of the United States and China on surveillance practices.

IV. References and Citations

- Reporters must provide proper references for all factual data, quotes, or figures used.
- Hyperlinks can be listed as endnotes at the conclusion of the article.
- For offline sources (books, physical documents), mention the title, author, and publishing body where possible.

V. Phrasing and Terminology

- Use complete, formal expressions. Avoid contractions such as “don’t,” “can’t,” or “shouldn’t.” Use “do not,” “cannot,” and “should not.”
- Avoid informal, rhetorical, or emotionally loaded expressions. Do not use phrases like “shockingly,” “amazingly,” or “ironically.”
- Refer to delegates strictly by their assigned roles. For example, “The delegate of France” or “The representative of the Republic of Korea.” Do not use individual names, even if known.

- Do not reference the Executive Board or Secretariat in article content. Sentences such as “The board passed a motion” or “The EB gave a lunch break” or “During a moderated caucus session on the topic ...” are strictly prohibited.
- **Avoid the use of symbols and shorthand in formal writing.** Symbols such as “%,” “&,” “+,” or abbreviations should not appear in article content. Use the full written form instead, such as “percent” rather than “%,” “and” rather than “&,” and “plus” rather than “+,” to maintain clarity, formality, and consistency.

VI. Visual Elements

As your article includes a photograph, infographic, and or a graph:

- Ensure it is relevant to the article’s subject.
- Mention the source or the name of the photojournalist via credits in 10 pt font below the image, in a textbox.
- Do not stretch or distort the image format.

VII. Deadlines and Late Submissions

- All article deadlines will be communicated by the Editorial Board at the beginning of each day’s session.
- Late submissions will only be accepted under exceptional circumstances and must be approved in advance.
- Additional or "brownie" submissions (voluntary extra articles) may be used to break ties in evaluation or to consider special recognition. These must also follow the standard format and be clearly labelled as such in the file name.

Adherence to these formatting and protocol standards is mandatory. These rules are not intended to restrict creativity but to uphold consistency and professionalism across our team’s work. Your cooperation ensures that editorial responsibilities remain manageable, and the final newsletter reflects a high standard of publication.

Rules of Conduct and Reporting Ethics

I. General Decorum and Professionalism

Journalists must maintain neutrality and composure in committees, avoiding disruptions. Interviews should be conducted during breaks with consent. Any issues during observation should be reported privately to the IP Executive Board.

II. Neutrality in Reporting

While opinions are allowed in editorials, factual accuracy must prevail. Personal biases, speculation, and inappropriate remarks, especially on sensitive topics, are prohibited.

III. Reference to Delegates and Portfolios

Delegates must be referred to by their assigned titles (e.g., “The delegate of France”),

never by personal names or real identifiers. Avoid bias when addressing ideologically aligned portfolios.

IV. Factual Integrity and Attribution

All reports must be accurate, with quotes and paraphrases reflecting original meanings. Avoid vague attributions and verify doubtful information.

V. Conduct in Sensitive Contexts

Respectful, fact-based coverage is required on topics of identity, policy, or rights. Avoid slogans, charged language, and disrespectful references.

VI. Violations and Editorial Action

Plagiarism, offensive content, or distortion of facts leads to disqualification or suspension. The editorial team may request revisions or withhold publication to uphold standards.

Evaluation Criteria

All submissions will be reviewed on the following parameters:

1. **Clarity and Structure:** Logical organisation and readability.
2. **Factual Accuracy:** Verified information with proper attribution.
3. **Language and Grammar:** Correct usage of British English, punctuation, and tone.
4. **Agenda Understanding:** Content must reflect accurate interpretation of the committee's context.
5. **Tone and Format Suitability:** Appropriate to the type of article submitted.
6. **Style Guide Compliance:** Adherence to formatting, file naming, and length requirements.
7. **Timeliness and Revisions:** On-time submissions and cooperation with editorial feedback.

These criteria ensure quality, consistency, and journalistic integrity across all submissions.

Final Remarks and Reporting Philosophy

The role of the International Press extends beyond deadlines and newsletters. It ends only when one question is answered: Did your writing capture what truly happened, beyond what was said? This guide has introduced the technical, procedural, and ethical aspects of Model UN journalism, but the real value lies in disciplined observation, measured judgment, and careful selection amid complexity.

Model UN simulates diplomacy's complexity, with the press reflecting it. Your words frame perception, preserve memory, and shape understanding. You are expected to observe with intent, question purposefully, and write with balance, without bias or provocation.

Perfection is unnecessary, but integrity is vital. Honest, informed, and well-constructed reporting achieves its purpose. The International Press is the event's intellectual conscience; watching, questioning, and recording what diplomacy leaves behind. The responsibility rests with you to bring clarity to ambiguity, structure to chaos, and meaning to silence.

Good Luck!

— End of Style Guide —